



City of Somerville, Massachusetts

City Council

Regular Meeting Agenda

Thursday, May 14, 2026

7:00 PM

**City Council Chamber and Remote
Participation**

Published May 12, 2026, 1:15 PM.

NOTICE: Pursuant to Chapter 2 of the Acts of 2025, this meeting of the City Council may be conducted via remote participation. We will post an audio recording, audiovideo recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of these proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting on the City of Somerville website and local cable access government channels.

Register at the following website to listen to this meeting live or to testify at any public hearing:
https://us02web.zoom.us/webinar/register/WN_9XKJ9iWHTxyFfoCal_H1XQ

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1. OPENING CEREMONIES

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| 1.1. | Roll Call
(ID # 26-0843) | Call of the Roll. |
| 1.2. | Remembrances
(ID # 26-0844) | Remembrances. |
| 1.3. | Minutes
(ID # 26-0845) | Approval of the Minutes of the Regular Meeting of March 26, 2026. |
| 1.4. | Minutes
(ID # 26-0847) | Approval of the Minutes of the Special Meeting of April 14, 2026. |
| 1.5. | Minutes
(ID # 26-0846) | Approval of the Minutes of the Regular Meeting of April 9, 2026. |

2. CITATIONS

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| 2.1. | Citation
(ID # 26-0748) | By Councilor McLaughlin
Commending Lillian Bartolucci on the auspicious occasion of her 100th birthday. |
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- 2.2. Citation By Councilor Ewen-Campen
(ID # [26-0828](#)) Commending the Salvation Army for their dedicated commitment and generosity in supporting the city.

3. PUBLIC HEARINGS

- 3.1. Grant of Location Eversource applying for a Grant of Location to install 10
(ID # [26-0750](#)) feet of conduit in Hudson Street, from Utility Pole 202/9 to a proposed new handhole next to 135 Hudson Street.
- 3.2. Grant of Location Verizon New England applying for a Grant of Location
(ID # [26-0751](#)) to install 4 feet of conduit in Pearl Street, from existing Manhole 44/52A to a proposed new handhole next to 115 Pearl Street.
- 3.3. Grant of Location Verizon New England applying for a Grant of Location
(ID # [26-0752](#)) to install 61 feet of conduit in Medford Street, from existing Manhole 44/430 to a proposed new handhole next to 350 Medford Street.

4. ORDERS, ORDINANCES, RESOLUTIONS AND MOTIONS OF MEMBERS

- 4.1. Resolution By Councilor Mbah and Councilor Hardt
(ID # [26-0821](#)) That the Administration, the Executive Director of the Office of Strategic Planning and Community Development, the Director of Health and Human Services, and the Director of the Office of Housing Stability, engage with leadership of Saint James Church to explore opportunities for partnership between the city and the church to activate underutilized space for community-serving purposes.
- 4.2. Resolution By Councilor Mbah and Councilor Hardt
(ID # [26-0822](#)) That the Director of Mobility install speed bumps on Elmwood Street and assess whether closing the street to non-residents during rush hours would be possible and useful to reduce the cut-through traffic to and from Cameron Avenue.
- 4.3. Communication By Councilor Mbah
(ID # [26-0823](#)) Conveying a report of the Job Creation and Retention Trust Fund.
- 4.4. Resolution By Councilor Sait and Councilor Clingan
(ID # [26-0805](#)) That the Director of Public Works place a portable restroom at Hoyt-Sullivan playground.

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| 4.5. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0806) | By Councilor Sait
That the Director of Mobility install a speed bump on Vernon Street. |
| 4.6. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0824) | By Councilor Strezo
That the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Coordinator submit a written report to this City Council regarding the timeline for ADA Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 under Title II, and the plan for its completion. |
| 4.7. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0825) | By Councilor Strezo
That the Administration submit a written report to this Council regarding the timeline and process for staffing the Americans with Disabilities (ADA) Coordinator role and update this Council on the plan to process ADA complaints and accessibility coordination when this position is vacant. |
| 4.8. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0826) | By Councilor Ewen-Campen and Councilor Wheeler
Supporting the Governor’s Executive Order “Facilitating Safe and Affordable Single-Stair Multifamily Residential Buildings”. |
| 4.9. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0827) | By Councilor Ewen-Campen
That the Administration work with the Massachusetts Department of Transportation to ensure that extremely loud construction does not occur overnight. |
| 4.10. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0831) | By Councilor Hardt
That the Executive Director of the Office of Strategic Planning and Community Development develop and share with the public, a list of all the spaces that are available for community use, including and especially those that are part of private developments. |
| 4.11. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0832) | By Councilor Hardt
That the Director of Water and Sewer provide an overview of the water and sewer metering and billing practices. |
| 4.12. | Resolution
(ID # 26-0834) | By Councilor Wheeler
That the Director of Planning, Preservation and Zoning consider revising the demolition review cutoff date to 1945, rather than a date relative to the present year. |
| 4.13. | Communication
(ID # 26-0833) | By Councilor Wheeler
Conveying the existing Body Worn Camera Policy. |
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| 4.14. Zoning Ordinance
(ID # 26-0835) | By Councilor Davis
Proposing an amendment to Section 2.1.1 of the Zoning Ordinance regarding Homeless Shelters. |
| 4.15. Resolution
(ID # 26-0836) | By Councilor McLaughlin
That the Commissioner of Public Works install a street light at the corner of Tufts and Washington Streets near the East Somerville Station crosswalk to increase visibility and pedestrian safety. |
| 4.16. Resolution
(ID # 26-0837) | By Councilor McLaughlin
That the Director of Mobility use urban Neighborways art on Perkins Street, in front of the playground, to increase pedestrian safety. |
| 4.17. Resolution
(ID # 26-0838) | By Councilor Link
That the Chief Information Officer provide this Council with a summary report on the current accessibility status of city-operated digital properties including websites, platforms, and portals, and share any plans to ensure new properties comply with Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) using principles like “accessibility-first design.” |
| 4.18. Order
(ID # 26-0839) | By Councilor Link
That the Commissioner of Public Works provide an update to this Council on improvements made to custodial staffing at the East Somerville Community School. |
| 4.19. Order
(ID # 26-0841) | By Councilor Link
That the Commissioner of Public Works provide an update on the improvements made to the temperature in the Edgerly Education Center Cafetorium and kitchen following the installation of the air conditioning unit. |
| 4.20. Resolution
(ID # 26-0840) | By Councilor Link and Councilor Ewen-Campen
That the Director of Mobility evaluate the feasibility of implementing a raised intersection or crosswalk at the intersection of Columbus Avenue, Prospect Hill Parkway, and Stone Avenue, and report findings to the City Council. |
| 4.21. Resolution
(ID # 26-0842) | By Councilor Link and Councilor Sait
That the Director of Public Space and Urban Forestry consider snow clearing requirements to maintain inclusive winter use when selecting turf materials for the new Kennedy School inclusive playground. |
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5. UNFINISHED BUSINESS**6. REPORTS OF COMMITTEES****6.A. CONFIRMATION OF APPOINTMENTS AND PERSONNEL MATTERS COMMITTEE**

- 6.A.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Confirmation of
(ID # [26-0814](#)) Appointments and Personnel Matters, meeting on May 4,
2026.

6.B. LAND USE COMMITTEE

- 6.B.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Land Use, meeting on May
(ID # [26-0816](#)) 7, 2026.

6.C. LEGISLATIVE MATTERS COMMITTEE

- 6.C.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Legislative Matters, meeting
(ID # [26-0811](#)) on April 28, 2026.

6.D. LEGISLATIVE MATTERS COMMITTEE

- 6.D.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Legislative Matters, meeting
(ID # [26-0815](#)) on May 5, 2026.

6.E. LICENSES AND PERMITS COMMITTEE

- 6.E.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Licenses and Permits,
(ID # [26-0817](#)) meeting on May 13, 2026.

6.F. SCHOOL BUILDING FACILITIES AND MAINTENANCE COMMITTEE

- 6.F.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on School Building Facilities
(ID # [26-0813](#)) and Maintenance, meeting on April 30, 2026.

6.G. SUSTAINABILITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE COMMITTEE

- 6.G.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Sustainability and
(ID # [26-0812](#)) Infrastructure, meeting on April 29, 2026.

6.H. TRAFFIC AND PARKING COMMITTEE

- 6.H.1. Committee Report Report of the Committee on Traffic and Parking, meeting
(ID # [26-0809](#)) on April 27, 2026.

7. COMMUNICATIONS OF THE MAYOR

- 7.1. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0745](#)) Requesting approval of an amendment to the Assembly Square District Improvement Financing District Map and Program to include the Assembly Square Fire Station, 45 Middlesex Avenue, and improvements to the intersection of Middlesex Avenue and Mystic Avenue.
- 7.2. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0797](#)) Requesting approval of a Home Rule Petition to authorize the City of Somerville to regulate leases and tenancy at will agreements.
- 7.3. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0746](#)) Requesting approval of the Urban Center Housing Tax Increment Financing (UCH-TIF) Zone, Plan, and Form of Agreement for Assembly Square and East Somerville .
- 7.4. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0818](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$3,940,905 from the Street Reconstruction and Resurfacing Stabilization Fund to the Street Resurfacing Bond Fund to pay down street reconstruction and resurfacing expenses.
- 7.5. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0808](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$2,381,625 from the Street Reconstruction and Resurfacing Stabilization Fund to the Somerville Avenue Streetscape Bond Fund to pay down capital expenses.
- 7.6. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0807](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$999,000 from the Facility Construction and Renovation Stabilization Fund to the Building Improvements Bond Fund to pay down building renovation expenses.
- 7.7. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0819](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$545,985 from the Capital Projects Stabilization Fund to Fire Pumper Bond Fund 51855 for the purposes of funding a new fire pumper.
- 7.8. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0820](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$532,449 from the Capital Projects Stabilization Fund to the Fire Pumper Bond Fund 5187 for the purpose of funding a new fire pumper.
- 7.9. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0810](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$320,000 from the Street Reconstruction and Resurfacing Stabilization Fund to the Union Square Streetscape and Plaza Bond Fund to pay down streetscape improvement expenses.
- 7.10. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-0803](#)) Requesting approval to appropriate \$182,469 from the Opioid Recovery and Remediation Stabilization fund for the Healthcare for the Homeless program.

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| 7.11. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0733) | Requesting approval of a transfer of \$4,000 from the Community Preservation Act (CPA) Undesignated Fund Balance to the CPA Historic Preservation Reserve. |
| 7.12. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0763) | Requesting approval to enter into a 60-month contract renewal term with Waste Management of Massachusetts Inc. for solid waste disposal. |
| 7.13. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0738) | Requesting approval to establish an Arts Council Furniture Account and to use \$2,000 in available funds from the Arts Council Professional & Technical Services Account to purchase new desks and chairs for staff. |
| 7.14. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0740) | Requesting approval of a time-only contract extension until 5/22/2027 for the contract with UELContractors Inc. for the completion of improvements at Junction Park. |
| 7.15. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0732) | Requesting approval to accept and expend an \$11,000 grant and a \$4,200 grant with no new match required, from the Department of Fire Services to the Fire Department for fire safety education and supplies for school children and senior citizens. |
| 7.16. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0707) | Requesting approval to pay prior year invoices totaling \$6,660 using available funds in the Police Department Maintenance Software Account for fingerprinting machine software. |
| 7.17. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0688) | Requesting approval of the 2026-2027 Housing and Urban Development One Year Action Plan for the Community Development Block Grant, Home Investment Partnership, and Emergency Solutions Grant programs. |
| 7.18. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0830) | Requesting approval of the Surveillance Technology Impact Report for CrimeTracer. |
| 7.19. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0729) | Requesting approval of an exemption for Linzy Buffington as required by Massachusetts General Law Chapter 268A, Section 20(b). |
| 7.20. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0730) | Requesting approval of an exemption for John Haverty as required by Massachusetts General Law, Chapter 268A, Section 20(b). |
| 7.21. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0731) | Requesting approval of an exemption for Peter George as required by Massachusetts General Law, Chapter 268A, Section 20(b). |
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| 7.22. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0829) | Requesting approval of an exemption for Jasper Coles as required by Massachusetts General Law Chapter 268A, Section 20(b). |
| 7.23. | Mayor's
Communication
(ID # 26-0741) | Proclaiming that the week of May 10 through May 17, 2026 is Taiwanese American Heritage Week. |
| 7.24. | Mayor's
Communication
(ID # 26-0742) | Proclaiming May 2026 to be Jewish American Heritage Month. |
| 7.25. | Mayor's
Communication
(ID # 26-0743) | Proclaiming May 2026 to be Haitian American Heritage Month. |
| 7.26. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0654) | Requesting confirmation of the appointment of Christopher Camara to the position of Police Officer. |
| 7.27. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0734) | Requesting confirmation of the appointment of Kaleigh Kosta to the position of Police Officer. |
| 7.28. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-0655) | Requesting confirmation of the appointment of Taylor Perkins to the Fair Housing Commission. |
| 7.29. | Mayor's
Communication
(ID # 26-0727) | Conveying the appointment of Georgy Cohen to the Public Financing of Campaigns Committee. |
| 7.30. | Withdrawn
(ID # 26-0719) | Withdrawn. |
| 7.31. | Withdrawn
(ID # 26-0498) | Withdrawn. |
| 7.32. | Withdrawn
(ID # 26-0728) | Withdrawn. |
| 7.33. | Withdrawn
(ID # 26-0737) | Withdrawn. |

8. COMMUNICATIONS OF CITY OFFICERS

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| 8.1. | Officer's
Communication
(ID # 26-0735) | City Clerk conveying her resignation, effective May 17, 2026. |
| 8.2. | Officer's
Communication
(ID # 26-0749) | City Clerk conveying Block Party Licenses issued. |
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9. NEW BUSINESS

- 9.1. License (ID # [26-0753](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, Alfa Excavation Inc.
- 9.2. License (ID # [26-0754](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, BSI Engineering.
- 9.3. License (ID # [26-0755](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, CRL Inc.
- 9.4. License (ID # [26-0756](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, F.E. French Construction Inc.
- 9.5. License (ID # [26-0757](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, J.J. Phelan & Son Co., Inc.
- 9.6. License (ID # [26-0758](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, Kealey Excavation Corporation.
- 9.7. License (ID # [26-0759](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, Milltown Plumbing & Heating Inc.
- 9.8. License (ID # [26-0760](#)) Renewing Drainlayer's License, Riccio Excavation.
- 9.9. License (ID # [26-0761](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Alfredo's Italian Kitchen, 288 Broadway.
- 9.10. License (ID # [26-0762](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Cataldo Ambulance Service Inc., 137 Washington Street.
- 9.11. License (ID # [26-0764](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Chow N Joy, 626 Somerville Avenue.
- 9.12. License (ID # [26-0765](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Eat Greek Gyros, 215 Elm Street.
- 9.13. License (ID # [26-0766](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Lemon Thai Cuisine, 215 Highland Avenue.
- 9.14. License (ID # [26-0767](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Lucky Strike, 325 Revolution Drive.
- 9.15. License (ID # [26-0769](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Mayer Campus Center, 44 Professors Row.
- 9.16. License (ID # [26-0768](#)) Renewing Extended Operating Hours License, Papa John's, 622 Somerville Avenue.

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| 9.17. | License
(ID # <u>26-0770</u>) | Renewing Flammables License, Hillside Auto Repair, Inc., 583 Broadway. |
| 9.18. | License
(ID # <u>26-0771</u>) | Renewing Flammables License, Somerville Mobil, 360 Medford Street. |
| 9.19. | License
(ID # <u>26-0772</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Auto Plus, 229 Lowell Street. |
| 9.20. | License
(ID # <u>26-0773</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Boston Sand and Gravel Company, 492R Rutherford Avenue. |
| 9.21. | License
(ID # <u>26-0774</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Building 2 Owner LLC, 808 Windsor Street. |
| 9.22. | License
(ID # <u>26-0775</u>) | Renewing Garage License, DW Propco EF LLC, 250 Water Street. |
| 9.23. | License
(ID # <u>26-0776</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Four Wheels Auto, 83A Albion Street. |
| 9.24. | License
(ID # <u>26-0777</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Fred M. Susan Auto Body, Inc., 269 Somerville Avenue. |
| 9.25. | License
(ID # <u>26-0778</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Green Automotive Inc., 600 Windsor Place. |
| 9.26. | License
(ID # <u>26-0779</u>) | Renewing Garage License, Somerville Auto Center, 193 Somerville Avenue. |
| 9.27. | License
(ID # <u>26-0780</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Yolande Trans., Inc., Med. #15. |
| 9.28. | License
(ID # <u>26-0781</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Green and Yellow TNC of Somerville, Med. #27,33,34,35,36,37,38,53,54,67,68. |
| 9.29. | License
(ID # <u>26-0782</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Mount Pleasant Taxi Inc, Med. #28,30,31,32,39,40,41,42,43. |
| 9.30. | License
(ID # <u>26-0783</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Early Bird Transportation, LLC, Med. #49. |
| 9.31. | License
(ID # <u>26-0784</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Charlie's Family LLC, Med. #80. |
| 9.32. | License
(ID # <u>26-0785</u>) | Renewing Taxi Medallion License, HollyPaul Desravines, Med. #92. |
| 9.33. | License
(ID # <u>26-0786</u>) | Renewing Taxi Stand License, Green and Yellow Cab, 1 Davis Square. |
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| 9.34. Public Event
(ID # 26-0789) | Office of Immigrant Affairs applying for a Public Event License for Haitian Flag Raising on May 18 from 2:30pm to 5:30pm. |
| 9.35. Public Event
(ID # 26-0790) | Office of Immigrant Affairs applying for a Public Event License for New England Hong Kong Festival on May 30 from 8am to 8pm (raindate May 31). |
| 9.36. Public Event
(ID # 26-0794) | Veterans Services Department applying for a Public Event License for Pride Flag Raising on June 4 from 4:30pm to 6:30pm. |
| 9.37. Public Event
(ID # 26-0796) | Mobility Division applying for a Public Event License for Quick Build Safety Improvements Open House on June 9 from 5pm to 8pm (raindate June 10). |
| 9.38. Public Event
(ID # 26-0791) | Department of Racial and Social Justice applying for a Public Event License for Juneteenth Flag Raising on June 16 from 11am to 1:30pm (raindate June 17). |
| 9.39. Public Event
(ID # 26-0788) | St. Anthony Parish applying for a Public Event License for Festa Junina 2026 on June 20 from 10am to 1am (raindate June 21). |
| 9.40. Public Event
(ID # 26-0787) | Parks and Recreation Department applying for a Public Event License for Family Fun Day on June 27 from 10am to 7:30pm. |
| 9.41. Public Event
(ID # 26-0795) | Citixen Joy LLC applying for a Public Event License for Somer Fest on July 25 from 10am to 7:30pm (raindate July 26). |
| 9.42. Public Event
(ID # 26-0793) | Alex Pickert applying for a Public Event License for NICE, a fest Vendor Market on July 25 and July 26 from 12pm to 12am. |
| 9.43. Public Event
(ID # 26-0792) | Police Department applying for a Public Event License for National Night Out on August 4 from 9am to 10:30pm (raindate August 5). |
| 9.44. Public Communication
(ID # 26-0798) | 25 residents submitting comments re: item #26-0287, a Zoning Text Amendment to amend the Zoning Ordinance sections 3.1.8c, 3.1.9c, 3.1.10c, 3.1.13k, 3.1.13l, 3.2.12l. and 3.2.12m. |
| 9.45. Public Communication
(ID # 26-0799) | Four residents submitting comments re: item #26-0484, Surveillance Technology Impact Report for Body Worn Cameras. |
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- 9.46. Public Communication (ID # [26-0800](#)) Dorinda Jaquith submitting comments re: parking permits.
- 9.47. Public Communication (ID # [26-0801](#)) Hayley Richards submitting comments re: Kensington Avenue.
- 9.48. Public Communication (ID # [26-0802](#)) Alison Davis submitting comments re: water in city parks.
- 9.49. Public Communication (ID # [26-0804](#)) Yes In My Backyard (YIMBY) submitting comments re: 90 Washington Street.

10. SUPPLEMENTAL ITEMS

11. ADJOURNMENT